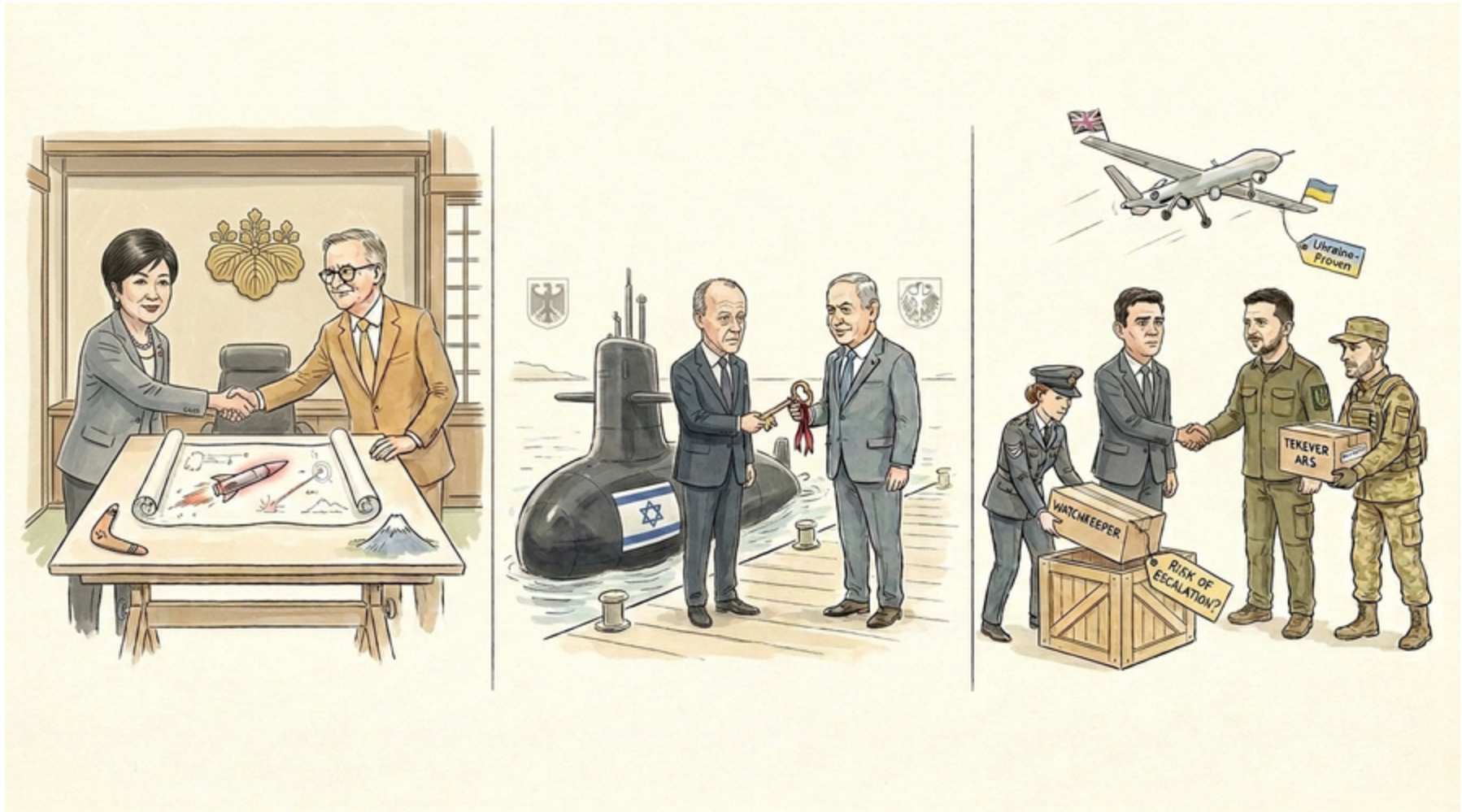


Defense Brief

August 21, 2026



Japan to Test Hypersonic Missiles on Australian Ranges Under New Boobook Laser Deal; Germany Handovers Nuclear-Capable Submarine to Israel as Arms Exports Surge

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The Bottom Line

Today's defense brief is dominated by procurement and industrial moves rather than battlefield shifts. Japan and Australia agreed a decade-long hypersonic test-and-laser cooperation pact, Germany quietly handed Israel a potentially VLS-equipped nuclear-capable submarine amid a surge in export licences, and the UK replaced Watchkeeper with Tekever's Ukraine-proven AR5. Meanwhile Ukraine's Fire Point has scaled to ~100 cruise missiles a month, the US Congress pushed \$500 million toward Taiwan despite Trump's hold on a larger package, and Canada's GCAP observer status opens industrial doors for CAE. The common thread: mid-tier and non-US powers are investing in low-cost long-range strike, directed energy, and sixth-generation supply-chain positions rather than waiting on US procurement cycles.

Read the full analysis at frontion.news